

Northstar Labs Information Security Policy

Version 1.0 – Internal Policy Document

Northstar Labs is a UK-based software development and AI solutions company committed to maintaining high standards of information security, data protection, and operational resilience. This policy outlines the organisation's approach to protecting company systems, customer data, and internal information assets.

Document Owner	Information Security Lead
Company	Northstar Labs
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1. Security Responsibilities

All employees, contractors, and third parties working on behalf of Northstar Labs are responsible for protecting company information and complying with security policies and procedures. Department managers are responsible for ensuring security controls are implemented within their teams. The engineering leadership team is responsible for maintaining secure development standards, vulnerability management, and infrastructure security practices. Security incidents, suspicious activity, or policy violations must be reported immediately to the Information Security Lead.

2. Access Control

Access to company systems, applications, repositories, and customer environments must follow the principle of least privilege. User accounts must be uniquely assigned to individuals and shared accounts are prohibited unless formally approved for operational reasons. Access reviews are conducted quarterly to ensure permissions remain appropriate for employee roles. Access is revoked promptly when employees leave the organisation or change roles.

3. Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA)

Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all cloud platforms, administrative accounts, source control platforms, VPN access, and business-critical systems. MFA methods must use approved authenticator applications or hardware security keys. SMS-based MFA should be avoided where stronger methods are available. Any systems identified without MFA protection must be escalated and remediated immediately.

4. Encryption Standards

Northstar Labs requires encryption for sensitive company and customer data both in transit and at rest. Industry-standard encryption protocols such as TLS 1.2 or higher must be used for external communications. Sensitive data stored within cloud environments, databases, laptops, and backups must be encrypted using approved encryption mechanisms such as AES-256. Encryption keys and secrets must be securely managed and stored using approved secrets-management platforms.

5. Asset Management

All company-owned devices and software assets must be recorded within the company asset register. Company laptops must use full disk encryption, endpoint protection software, automatic screen locking, and device management controls. Employees are responsible for maintaining the physical security of company devices and reporting lost or stolen equipment immediately. Unsupported or end-of-life software must not be used within production environments.

6. Employee Security Expectations

Employees are expected to complete mandatory annual security awareness training. Staff must follow secure password practices, protect confidential information, and avoid sharing sensitive data through unauthorised channels. Personal devices may only access company systems where approved security controls are in place. Employees must remain vigilant against phishing attempts, social engineering, and unauthorised access attempts.

7. Security Governance

Northstar Labs maintains a security governance framework designed to support secure software delivery, customer trust, and regulatory compliance. Security policies are reviewed annually or following significant organisational or technical changes. Risk assessments are conducted regularly to identify and manage security risks affecting the organisation. The company maintains incident response procedures, vulnerability management processes, and business continuity planning to support operational resilience.